January 1910.[3] These rumours gained strength when Ganapathia Pillai and Ramaier again left for Colombo on 30 December 1909, returning on 4 January 1910.[4] On 20 January, B.K. Ramaier came to Tuticorin from Tirunelveli en route to Colombo, accompanied by K.R. Venkatarama Aiyar and P.V. Ganapathia Pillai. Two days later the former returned to Tuticorin and left for Madurai immediately while the latter returned to Tuticorin two days after him.[5] The police reports are frustrating. While SSNCo's members were shadowed relentlessly and their movements tracked, nothing is known of what they did during these incessant, and ultimately, futile travels.

S.D. Krishna Aiyangar too was constantly on the move. On occasions, he lived on the ship for several days, and he stayed in Colombo for some days every month to attend to work related to the company.[6] He was in Bombay for some time in mid-December 1909—we do not know for how long and what business he transacted— and only returned to Tuticorin via Colombo on 23 December 1909.[7]

There were some developments during S.D. Krishna Aiyangar's visit to Bombay in late January 1910 even if they might not have been positive.[8] Three days after his return from Bombay, on 3 February, the Bombay shipping magnate, Essaji Tajbhoy of Shah Line Company, who had caused much misery to the company, arrived at Tuticorin by train leaving for Colombo the next day.[9] Krishna Aiyangar followed him to Colombo two days later.[10] The purpose, according to the CID, was to arrange the charter of the *Lawoe* for the Bengal Steam Navigation Company in which Essaji Tajbhoy held a big stake. Reportedly, he had also promised to tow the *Gallia* to Bombay by the *Margarita*, a steamer he had purchased at Tuticorin. The Swadeshi company's plan was to use the proceeds from chartering the *Lawoe* to salvage whatever was possible to repair the *Gallia*.[11].

Even as these efforts were on, in February, the Swadeshi company planned to despatch the *Miranda* to Rameswaram. The idea was to ply the steam launch between the famous pilgrim town and Pamban, as large pilgrim crowds gathered during the auspicious new moon day (9–10